Name: SHASHWAT KUMAR
Registration number: RA2511003011035
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21LEM202T — Unit 4, Session 9, SLO 2

PART A Key Ideas — Recap

The holistic approach (Samadhan) addresses problems at their root through human education, conduct, constitution and order, rather than symptomatic relief. Efforts within the existing system include natural farming, reversing desertification, right utilisation of forests and wetlands, desert water management, and urban water harvesting. The study project 'Sourabha' in Vijayanagar, Bangalore, demonstrates a 2,400 sq ft plot entirely dependent on rainwater since 1994. Our role includes value education, value-based living, walking/cycling, planting trees, water harvesting, and reducing-recycling-reusing. Typical efforts include making nests for birds, planting trees, restoring rivulets, and urban water harvesting. The UHV-volunteer effort by Pratibha and Mahesh Kolte involves natural farming and cooperative distribution to ~1000 families.

PART B In-Class Activities

In-class activities involve engaging with the holistic approach, reading real-world efforts as evidence that harmony with nature is workable, and moving from 'what is wrong' to 'what can be done' at the level of self, family and society.

Activity B1 — Sort each statement under Current Approach or Work to be Done in Society.

Write each statement in the correct column.

Items: Treat population / water scarcity as symptoms • Clarity of the all-encompassing solution (Samadhan) • Technology as temporary symptomatic relief • Ensure human conduct through human education • Human Education, Conduct, Constitution and Order

Current Approach	Work to be Done in Society
Treat population / water scarcity as symptoms	Clarity of the all-encompassing solution (Samadhan)
Technology as temporary symptomatic relief	Ensure human conduct through human education
	Human Education, Conduct, Constitution and Order

Activity B2 — Match each effort to its place/person.

Natural Farming → Maharashtra — Subhash Sharma

Reversing Desertification → Allan Savory — 5 continents

Desert Water Management → Rajasthan — Anupam Mishra

Urban Water Harvesting → Karnataka — Vijayanagar/Bengaluru

Cooperative natural-produce distribution → Pune — Pratibha & Mahesh Kolte

Item	Your match
Natural Farming	Maharashtra — Subhash Sharma
Reversing Desertification	Allan Savory — 5 continents
Desert Water Management	Rajasthan — Anupam Mishra
Urban Water Harvesting	Karnataka — Vijayanagar/Bengaluru
Cooperative natural-produce distribution	Pune — Pratibha & Mahesh Kolte

Activity B3 — Fill in the Sourabha rainwater-project figures.

Statement	Your answer
Plot area **4000** sq ft; built in **2002**.	Plot area **4000** sq ft; built in **2002**.
Entirely rainwater-dependent since **2002**.	Entirely rainwater-dependent since **2002**.
Annual rainfall ~**800** mm.	Annual rainfall ~**800** mm.
Collection ~**1,00,000** lts/year; need ~**80,000** lts/year.	Collection ~**1,00,000** lts/year; need ~**80,000** lts/year.
It recharges **groundwater**.	It recharges **groundwater**.

PART C Long-Answer Questions

Q1. Explain the four-step holistic approach (Samadhan) and how it differs from the "current approach" of symptomatic, technological relief.

The four-step holistic approach (Samadhan) consists of: (1) understanding the underlying problem at the level of human values and conduct, (2) ensuring human education that fosters right understanding, (3) establishing human conduct based on that understanding, and (4) creating a social order (constitution and systems) that supports such conduct. It differs from the current approach because the current approach treats symptoms like water scarcity or population as isolated problems and applies technological fixes that provide only temporary relief, whereas Samadhan addresses the root cause — lack of right understanding and human conduct — leading to sustainable, all-encompassing solutions.

Q2. Choose any three efforts from "Our Role in Sustaining Harmony in Nature" and explain how each, if practised widely, would help resolve problems studied in earlier sessions.

1. **Natural Farming**: If practised widely, it would eliminate the need for chemical fertilisers and pesticides, reducing soil degradation and water pollution — problems studied in earlier sessions on soil health and water contamination. 2. **Urban Water Harvesting**: Widespread adoption would recharge local groundwater, reduce dependence on distant reservoirs, and mitigate urban flooding, directly addressing water scarcity and mismanagement discussed earlier. 3. **Cooperative natural-produce distribution**: This would create a fair, localised supply chain, reducing transportation emissions and food waste, while supporting small farmers — tackling issues of unsustainable consumption and economic disparity.

Q3. The Sourabha project meets all its water needs from rainwater with no municipal connection. What does this example demonstrate about right utilisation and the human role in nature?

The Sourabha project demonstrates that right utilisation means using natural resources in a way that meets human needs without depleting or damaging the ecosystem. It shows that the human role in nature is not to dominate or exploit, but to live in harmony by designing systems that work with natural cycles — in this case, capturing and recharging rainwater locally. This example proves that with proper understanding and design, humans can be self-reliant and regenerative, rather than extractive and dependent on centralised infrastructure.

Self-Reflection (Take-Home) / Identify one "effort within the existing system" you could start or support locally. / Draft a three-point personal "value-based living" pledge for harmony with nature.

Effort within the existing system: I could start a community rainwater harvesting initiative by installing a simple rooftop collection system at my home and encouraging neighbours to do the same through a local workshop.

Three-point personal pledge:

1. I will reduce my water footprint by collecting and reusing rainwater and greywater.

2. I will choose locally grown, seasonal food to minimise transportation and support sustainable farming.

3. I will practice mindful consumption — repairing items instead of discarding them and composting organic waste to return nutrients to the soil.